SHANMATHI SIVAKUMAR

INTERIOR DESIGNER · RESIDENTIAL DESIGN STUDIO & CLIENT SELECTIONS

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LOCATION
Dallas, TX · Work authorized

Interior designer with 6+ years delivering residential and commercial interiors from concept through installation. Leads client selection meetings end to end — curated finish options at defined price points, bills of quantities, and realistic budget trade-offs. Produces complete construction and millwork documentation and has built material catalogs and drawing standards for two studios. Hands-on with the DFW production-builder design-center process through two recent new-build homes.

HIGHLIGHTS

Projects delivered	55+ residential, retail, hospitality, and commercial interiors across three studios and independent practice
Client selections	Lead buyer for 15+ projects — ran every selection meeting, built every BOQ, sourced in person with clients
Studio systems	Built a material catalog, vendor database, and design-language standards from zero at DesignInk
Team leadership	Prioritized work for a 10+ person team across live projects and competitive proposals at Taamaesek

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

FREELANCE RESIDENTIAL DESIGNER
Independent
Dallas–Fort Worth, TX
2026 – Present

- Designed and specified a full DFW new-build home from floor-plan selection to move-in — kitchen and bath layouts, cabinetry, countertops, tile, flooring, fixtures, paint scheme, furnishings — coordinating selections and changes directly with the builder.
- Guided a client through a production builder's design center and construction process: redesigned the kitchen layout, selected finishes, set the whole-house color scheme, and planned electrical, multimedia, and outlet locations in on-site builder meetings.
- Built option comparisons and budget trade-offs so the client chose upgrades with a clear view of cost versus impact; use Claude, Midjourney, and Google Flow to generate mood boards and early option studies in hours instead of days.

PROJECT DESIGNER & LEAD BUYER / PROCUREMENT
DesignInk Interiors and Architecture
Chennai, India
2023 – 2025

- Led 15+ residential, retail, and commercial interiors end to end — concept, client selections, construction and millwork documentation, procurement, site execution.
- Ran all client selection meetings as lead buyer: presented finish, fixture, and FF&E options across price points, walked clients through budget trade-offs, and locked selections against approved budgets.
- Built a bill of quantities and cost breakdown for every project and used it live with clients to show the cost impact of each upgrade before approval.
- Accompanied clients to showrooms and vendors to select tile, stone, hardware, lighting, and furnishings; developed mood boards and material palettes with them, iterating until design, budget, and style aligned.
- Created the studio's first centralized material catalog and vendor database, and established its design-language system — standard templates, detailing guidelines, documentation process — cutting rework at drafter and site handoffs.
- Prepared construction documents, millwork and cabinet shop drawings, and interior specifications; redlined drafter output for material locations, interior elevations, and details.

SENIOR DESIGNER
Auroma Architecture
Pondicherry, India
2022 – 2023 (remote)

- Delivered a full sustainable residential project remotely, concept through construction documentation, with GRIHA green-building detailing and a locally sourced material story.
- Maintained the studio's standard drawing templates and detail libraries and moved project documentation to a shared cloud workspace for remote and site teams.

ARCHITECT / DESIGNER & TEAM LEAD
Taamaesek Engineering Consortium
Chennai, India
2019 – 2022

- Led and prioritized work for a 10+ member multidisciplinary team across 30+ architecture and interior projects, balancing new-proposal design packages against live project deadlines.
- Contributed to TIDEL Park interiors, Thiru Vi. Ka Park redevelopment, and Chennai Metro Rail public squares; owned concept, interior detailing, BOQs, material selection, and construction and as-built drawings.
- Ran feasibility and financial studies for renovating 20+ government hostels — one repeatable spec-and-budget package applied across sites.
- Represented the team in client and stakeholder reviews to keep scope, budget, and schedule aligned.

DESIGNER
Aturvya Architects
Chennai, India
2018 – 2019

- Delivered 10+ residential interiors — space planning, detailing, carpentry and millwork packages, working drawings.
- Handled material selection, vendor coordination, site supervision, and client presentations.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Client Selections — Selection meetings · Tiered option packages · Budget trade-offs · Showroom and vendor sourcing · Bills of quantities

Design — Space planning · Kitchen and bath layouts · Concept development · Mood boards · Material palettes · FF&E · Color schemes

Documentation — Construction drawings · Millwork and cabinet shop drawings · Interior elevations and details · Specifications · Redlines · As-builts

Studio Systems — Material catalogs · Vendor databases · Drawing templates and detailing standards · Cloud workspaces

Coordination — Site and builder coordination · Electrical and multimedia planning · Procurement · Quality control · Team prioritization

SOFTWARE

Drafting & Redlining — AutoCAD · Revit · SketchUp · Rhino · Bluebeam Revu (building proficiency)

Visualization — V-Ray · Lumion · Enscape · D5 Render

AI Design Tools — Claude (Design, concept and spec writing) · Midjourney · Google Flow · ChatGPT — used for mood-board generation, option studies, and client presentation drafts

Presentation — Adobe Photoshop · Adobe Lightroom · MS Office

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Architecture — Anna University, Chennai, India · 2014 – 2019 · Thesis awarded top of class